

New Fusion from AMD?

AMD is expected to launch a new quad-core Fusion processor named A8-3530MX, designed for full-fledged laptops, in June.

Google buys Modu

Google has bought Israeli phone maker Modu, a company known for the lightest phone and lightest touchscreen phones in the world. Maybe, we'll soon have a Android Modu T?

Google announces the Chromebook

Google had announced the Chrome OS long back and we've also seen the prototype Chrome OS netbook Cr-48 being sent out for beta testing. At its I/O developer event, Google finally announced the Chromebook. Starting June 15th, Chromebooks will be available for purchase in the US, the UK, France, Germany, Netherlands, Italy and Spain, with more countries to follow after that. Devices by Samsung and Acer are available on Amazon and BestBuy. What's so special about the Chromebook?

- The Chromebook is a computer designed to work with Chrome OS.
- It has a special boot process that makes Chrome OS start quickly – in eight seconds.
- The boot process verifies your Chrome OS install ensuring that it isn't tampered with and thus free of viruses and other malware. If there's any tampering, the

system is repaired automatically.

- The Chromebook supports Wi-Fi and 3G.
- The Chromebook runs Chrome OS.
- Chrome OS is a Linux-based OS that is optimised to run only the Google Chrome browser.
- Chrome OS doesn't have any applications installed on it, other than the Chrome browser.
- One can't install traditional Windows, Mac OS X or even Linux apps on Chrome OS.
- All your work needs to be done online using tools such as Google Docs (office applications), Piknik (Image editing), Gmail (email).
- One can install web apps from the Google Chrome Web Store (now including the popular Angry Birds).
- Chrome OS is stateless. i.e. since all your operations are performed on the cloud your netbook itself stores

nothing. You can discard it, log in from another device and have the same experience.

- Chrome OS updates automatically.
- Chrome OS encrypts your data, so even if your device is lost, your data is safe.

Google will also offer these devices on a subscription-based model for Chromebooks, at a price of ₹1,271 per user per month for businesses and ₹900

per user per month for educational institutions. "Enterprise-level support, device warranties and replacements as well as regular hardware refreshes" will be included in this subscription model, and so will a web-based management console that will "include inventory management, software application management, printer management, network configuration, status monitoring and reporting." ■

Apple iPad 2 launched in India



Acer brings Iconia tablets and notebooks to India

Acer has been very nice, and launched three great new devices in India, at pretty much the same time as the rest of the world. These are the Iconia Tab A500 – a 10-inch Android Honeycomb tablet with a Tegra 2 dual-core processor for ₹27,990; the Iconia Tab W500 – a 10-inch Windows 7 tablet with a 1GHz AMD Fusion dual-core processor and 32GB SSD for

₹32,499; and the Iconia laptop – a 14-inch Windows 7 based dual-screen notebook with full featured specs for ₹69,999.

Acer also introduced the Iconia Smart A300 smart-phone-tablet hybrid, which runs on Android 2.3 Gingerbread, and a 7-inch Honeycomb tablet – the Iconia Tab A100. Both devices are expected to arrive in July, and so far, no pricing has been fixed for them. ■

Apple finally launched the new iPad 2 in India on April 29th. The news took much of India by surprise as it had taken Apple a little over a month after iPad 2's US launch for it to bring its latest tablet to India. This was surprising as the first generation iPad took over nine months to make it to the Indian market. All this is more than a small blow for the new Indian iPad owners, who never suspected the iPad 2 to launch so soon.

Unlike its US twin, iPad 2 in India is slightly more expensive than the model it replaces.

The first generation of iPad was launched at ₹27,900, which later dropped to ₹24,500. The iPad 2 starts at ₹29,500 and goes all the way up to ₹46,900, which is quite a hefty sum to pay for a tablet. But then it's an Apple product and the software giant is known for its premium pricing.

The following are the maximum retail prices of all the models including VAT.

- 16GB Wi-Fi: ₹29,500
- 32GB Wi-Fi: ₹34,500
- 64GB Wi-Fi: ₹39,500
- 16GB 3G + Wi-Fi: ₹36,900
- 32GB 3G + Wi-Fi: ₹41,900
- 64GB 3G + Wi-Fi: ₹46,900